When constant g is not enough

antocciphysics

Name: _____ **Block:** _____ (teacher only) **Mastery Rating:** _____

LEARNING TARGET Recognize the limits of the near-surface mgh model.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I can...

1. Compare altitude with planetary radius.
2. Explain that gravitational field weakens with center distance.
3. Choose a model appropriate to the height interval.

Core: teacher selects from 1-7. **Stretch:** 8 after checking your work.

MARZANO SELF-CHECK

① Need help starting

② Can do part; need help

③ Solve and explain with allowed supports

LANGUAGE GOAL Use “assumption” and “field” to explain your model or result. Sentence starters are optional.

assumption: a condition accepted for using a model

field: a description of an influence at each location

potential energy: energy associated with the configuration of interacting objects

01 Bring back an earlier idea

A cart begins with 15 J kinetic energy and gains 7 J net work.
Find final kinetic energy.

Word help: kinetic energy = energy associated with motion

Sentence starter: I found ... [unit]. This value means ... in this situation.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

02 Explain a worked example

Reference: $\Delta U \approx mg\Delta h$; $g = GM/r^2$.
The first relation needs nearly constant g. For large changes in r, the field changes; one fixed surface value is insufficient.

Worked reasoning: A local model treats g as constant over small height changes. At a center distance twice a planet's radius, however, g is only one quarter of its surface value.

Your turn: Sketch a planet and mark center distances R and 2 R.
Explain why one surface g cannot describe the entire trip exactly.

Sentence starter: My design shows ... . It meets the requirement by ... .

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

03 Look and explain

Compare lifting a book 1 m with moving a satellite one planetary radius above the surface. Which better fits constant g and why?

Sentence starter: Both ... . They differ in ... because ... .

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

04 Build the solution

Surface g is 12 N/kg. At center distance 2 R it is 3 N/kg. Would using 12 N/kg for the entire trip overestimate or underestimate required lifting energy?
Explain.

Sentence starter: My claim is ... . The diagram/data show ..., so ... .

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

Read down the left column, then down the right. Use the open space to draw, calculate and explain.

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Continue down each column.

Sentence starters are optional. You may plan in any language.

05 Use the idea

Why is altitude h not interchangeable with center-to-center r in the universal expression?

Sentence starter: My claim is … . The diagram/data show …, so … .

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

06 Choose a method

A system’s total momentum is 24 kg·m/s west and 32 kg·m/s south. Its combined mass is 4 kg.
Find final velocity components.

Word help: system = the object or objects chosen for analysis

Sentence starter: I found … [unit]. This value means … in this situation.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

07 Exit check

Choose the better description for a small classroom lift: constant g / strongly changing g.
State a reason.

Sentence starter: I notice … . This supports … because … .

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

08 STRETCH: Apply it another way

A planet's surface field is 12 N/kg.
Compare it at altitudes much smaller than R and at h=R. Which is better suited to constant-g reasoning?

Sentence starter: Both … . They differ in … because … .

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3